

STATEMENT & ASSUMPTION

1. What is a Statement?

A statement is a sentence that gives information, advice, an opinion, a warning, or a proposal.

Examples:

“The roads are wet.”

“Please wear a helmet.”

“The company should train new employees.”

“Buy this phone for a better camera.”

2. What is an Assumption?

An assumption is an idea that is taken for granted.

It is usually NOT directly stated.

It is a hidden belief necessary for the statement to make sense.

Think: “The speaker/writer is assuming that ...”

It is an idea that the speaker believes, even though it is not always mentioned. { hidden thought in statement }

Exam focus: Is the assumption implicit? (True or relevant)

3. Easy Example

Statement: “Please close the window.”

Possible assumption: “The window is open.”

Why? If the window were already closed, the request would not make sense.

Not necessarily an assumption: “It is raining outside.”

Remember: an assumption must be necessary—not merely possible.

4. The Best Exam Test: NEGATION TEST

Take the proposed assumption and imagine that it is NOT true.

If the statement becomes unreasonable / meaningless, the assumption is implicit.

Example:

Statement: “Use this app to save time.”

Assumption: “Users want to save time.” → If users did NOT want to save time, the suggestion loses its purpose. ✓

Assumption: “The app was launched last year.” → Not necessary. ✗

5. Common Types of Assumptions

Advice / suggestion → assumes the suggested action is useful.

“Take an umbrella.” → It may rain / umbrella protects from rain.

Advertisement → assumes customers want the advertised benefit.

“Buy our toothpaste for healthy teeth.” → People want healthy teeth.

Warning → assumes the danger is relevant or possible.

“Do not drive fast.” → High speed can be dangerous.

Proposal → assumes the proposal can solve or improve the problem.

6. Assumption vs Fact vs Conclusion

FACT: directly given or objectively stated.

ASSUMPTION: hidden idea taken for granted.

CONCLUSION: idea reached after considering information/evidence.

Example: “Ravi studied hard. Therefore, Ravi will pass.”

Fact: Ravi studied hard.

Assumption: Studying hard can help him pass.

Conclusion: Ravi will pass.

7. Four-Step Method for Every Question

STEP 1 — Read the statement carefully.

STEP 2 — Ask: “What does the speaker take for granted?”

STEP 3 — Apply the negation test to each assumption.

STEP 4 — Select only the assumptions that are necessary.

Do NOT use outside knowledge unless the question clearly requires it.

8. Watch Out for These Traps

- ✗ A possibility is not automatically an assumption.
- ✗ A consequence is not automatically an assumption.
- ✗ Something that is generally true is not necessarily assumed.
- ✗ Your personal opinion is irrelevant.
- ✗ Extreme words such as “always”, “everyone”, and “only” are often traps.
- ✓ Look for the minimum idea required for the statement to work.

Question 1

Statement:

“Please carry an umbrella because it may rain today.”

Assumptions:

- I. The person carrying the umbrella may be exposed to rain today
- II. An umbrella can protect a person from rain.

Options:

- A. Only I is implicit
- B. Only II is implicit
- C. Both I and II are implicit
- D. Neither I nor II is implicit

KEY: C

Why? Both ideas support the reason for the advice.

Question 2

Statement:

“Use our toothpaste to keep your teeth healthy.”

Assumptions:

- I. People want to keep their teeth healthy.
- II. The toothpaste is expected to help maintain dental health.

Options:

- A. Only I
- B. Only II
- C. Both I and II
- D. Neither I nor II

KEY: C

Why? The advertisement depends on both the customer's desire and the claimed benefit.

Question 3

Statement:

“The school should conduct extra classes for weak students.”

Assumptions:

- I. Some students need additional academic support.
- II. Extra classes may help such students improve.

Options:

- A. Only I
- B. Only II
- C. Both I and II
- D. Neither I nor II

KEY: C

Why? The proposal assumes a need and that the proposed action can help.

Question 4

“Drivers should wear seat belts while driving.”

Assumptions:

- I. Seat belts provide safety to drivers.
- II. Wearing a seat belt can reduce the risk of injury in an accident.

Options:

- A. Only I is implicit.
- B. Only II is implicit.
- C. Both I and II are implicit.
- D. Neither I nor II is implicit

KEY: C

Question 5

Statement:

“The government should open more public libraries in rural areas.”

Assumptions:

- I. Rural areas do not have sufficient access to public libraries.**
- II. More libraries could improve access to reading resources.**

Options:

- A. Only I
- B. Only II
- C. Both I and II
- D. Neither I nor II

KEY: C

Why? The proposal requires both a problem and a belief that the proposal can address it.

9. Slightly Tricky Example

Statement: “The roads are wet, so it must have rained.”

Is “It rained” an assumption?

Answer: NO.

Why? Wet roads can have other causes: a water tanker, road cleaning, a broken pipe, etc.

Lesson: Do not treat one possible explanation as a necessary assumption.

10. Final Revision — Remember This!

ASSUMPTION = Hidden idea taken for granted.

Ask: “What must be true for this statement to make sense?”

Use the NEGATION TEST.

Choose what is NECESSARY, not merely POSSIBLE.

Do not confuse assumption with conclusion or personal opinion.

**Exam mantra: READ → FIND HIDDEN IDEA → NEGATE → CHECK
NECESSITY → ANSWER**

THANKS